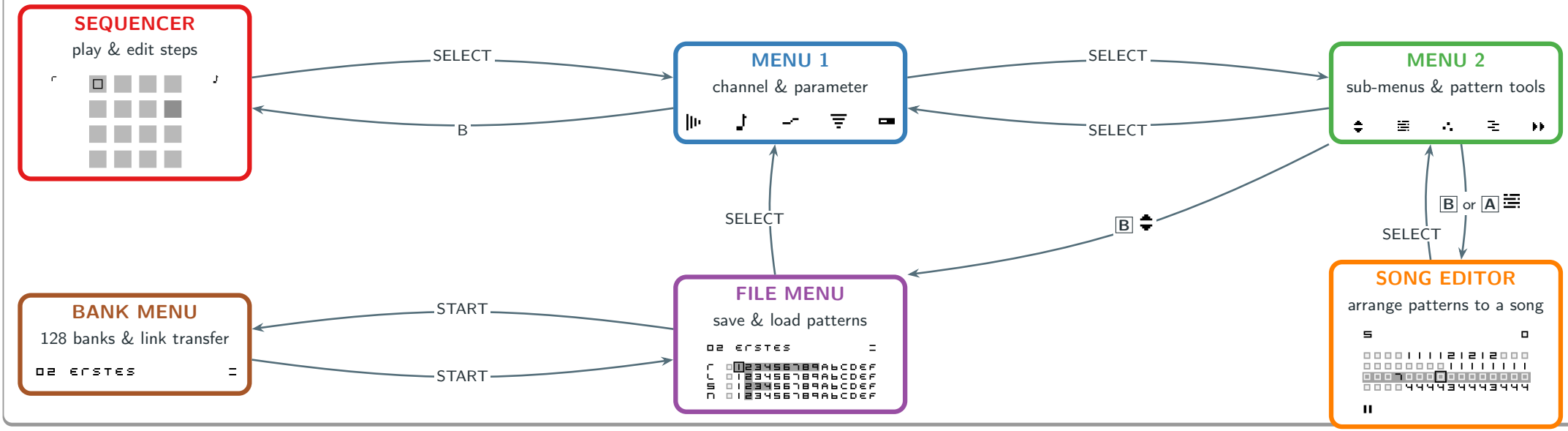
nanoloop 2 · cheatsheet

unofficial summary of the official 2.8 manual · GBA cart & Analogue Pocket built-in version

Notation: [B]+▲ = hold [B], tap D-pad up. All sound parameters are set *per step* – there are no instruments. Channel is shown top-left, edit parameter top-right.

WORKFLOW – modes & how to move between them



THE SEQUENCER

16 steps in a 4×4 grid; the playing step is darker.

- ▲▼◀▶ ..... move cursor
- [B] ..... place note
- [A] ..... cut note / paste on empty step
- [B]+▲▼◀▶ ..... edit note (current parameter)
- [A]+▲▼◀▶ ..... edit extra parameters
- [START] ..... mono / chord mode (pitch param)
- [R]+◀▶ ..... meta step
- [SELECT] ..... menu 1

Default parameter is pitch: [B]+▲▼ semitone, [B]+◀▶ octave.

***Meta step:** [R]+◀/▶/▼ makes a step play only every 2nd or 4th pattern round.*

CHANNELS

- [r] ..... mono, arp, pitch env/LFO
- [l] ..... mono, same as r
- [s] ..... poly, real chords, stereo
- [n] ..... noise, filter/speed, arp

r/l/s: filtered pulse wave (variable width) or FM (mod amount + freq). s adds stereo phasing + filter/mod env; n arp is on speed. On n, [L] toggles GB noise 16/8-bit (waveform).

SYNC

- [S8] ..... click every 2nd step (default)
- [S16] ..... 1 click per step
- [S24] ..... 3 clicks/step (MIDI adaptor)
- [SY1] ..... left-ch. clicks (PO slave)
- [A]+▲▼ ..... set mode (in menu 2)
- [B]+[SELECT] ..... CV sync (slave)
- [B] ..... start: pattern-sync
- [A] ..... start: manual / external

CV sync: "c" under the tempo, 1 pulse per step. MIDI clock out via the link port (Pocket-to-MIDI cable).

***Manual start:** [START] begins at once and sends sync; [B]+[A] = slave. **S16 auto-revert:** no clock for ~2 s → back to step 1.*

LEGEND – terms

pattern 16-step loop of notes + per-step settings
channel one of 4 voices: r, l, s tonal, n noise
step one of 16 positions in a pattern
slot cell storing one pattern; 15 per channel
bank full set of slots; 128 of them
song patterns chained to play in order
file menu to save / load patterns

MENU 1 – channel & parameter

◀▶ ..... select parameter
▲▼ ..... select channel
A + START ..... mute / unmute ch.
R + START ..... value / bar view
B ..... back to sequencer
R + ▲▼◀▶ ..... randomise
R + SELECT ..... new / legacy mode
SELECT ..... menu 2

Randomise: repeat presses widen the range. Legacy mode: A + D-pad edits only (pre-2.8 style).

PITCH / CHORD

Pitch is per step; chords are four notes, edited one at a time.

B + ▲▼ ..... semitone
B + ◀▶ ..... octave
START ..... chord mode on/off
B + START ..... rel. / abs. chord
A + ▲▼ ..... chord interval
A + ◀▶ ..... select chord step
L ..... arpeggio env. on/off

Chords: arpeggio on r/l, polyphonic on s. n has no pitch – always arpeggio (on playback frequency). Chord step: top note = pause.

VOLUME / ENVELOPE

Volume + D / AD / gate envelope.

B + ▲▼ ..... volume
B + ◀▶ ..... length
A + ▲▼ ..... envelope: D / AD / gate
A + ◀▶ ..... click (r) / soft (l,s,n)

D = decay; AD = attack = decay; gate holds full level; far right = infinite.

BEND / LFO

Bend envelope / LFO on pitch and filter.

B + ▲▼ ..... amplitude
B + ◀▶ ..... length / frequency
A + ▲▼ ..... envelope / LFO
A + ◀▶ ..... pitch / filter (s)

On pitch (r,l,s) + filter/FM (s,n): lower half retriggered, upper free.

WAVEFORM

Pulse wave or FM, per step.

B + ▲▼ ..... cutoff / FM modulation
B + ◀▶ ..... pulse width / mod freq
A + ▲ ..... FM (r,l,s) / GB noise (n)
A + ▼ ..... PWM / highpass noise (n)
A + ▶ ..... bandpass / metallic noise
A + ◀ ..... highpass / white noise

On n: B + ◀▶ = noise speed.

PAN / DELAY

Stereo position + echo delay.

B + ◀▶ ..... panning (s,n)
A + ▲▼ ..... delay / delay + orig.
B + ▲▼ ..... delay

Editing delay for all notes from menu 1 hits only even steps – that is the swing control.

MENU 2 – sub-menus & pattern tools

B (or A) opens the selected sub-menu / function below
SELECT ..... back to menu 1
A + ▲▼ ..... sync mode (page 1)

PING-PONG

B + ◀ ..... on
START ..... random
B + ▶ ..... normal (off)

SHIFT

B + ▲▼ ..... length
B + ◀▶ ..... shift
A + ◀▶ ..... shift+delay
START ..... copy pattern
A + B ..... paste

TEMPO

B + ◀▶ ..... tempo
B + ▲▼ ..... 1/x tempo
START ... start / master
A + B ..... stop / slave
A ..... pause / step
B ..... resume

SONG EDITOR

B + ▲▼ ..... select pattern
B + ◀▶ ..... copy value to next
A + ▲ ..... load patterns @ cursor
A + ◀▶ ..... turn page (15 pages)
R ..... channel follows tempo
L ..... channel follows length
START ..... start song at cursor
SELECT ..... back to menu 2

Saved on leaving the editor, not on power-off. Tempo is stored per pattern.

FILE MENU

128 banks × 15 slots per channel. Slot 0 is read-only (loads an empty pattern). The bank also carries the waveforms – switching banks can change the sound at once.

▲▼ select channel · ◀▶ select slot · START bank menu · SELECT back to menu 1

B + ▼ ..... save pattern to slot
B + R + ▲ ..... load pattern + tempo
A + B + ▲ ..... load column @ step 1
A + ◀▶ ..... next column + load all
A + B + ◀▶ ..... mute/unmute/solo
B + ▲ ..... load pattern
A + ▲ ..... load column
B + ◀▶ ..... next slot + load
A + ▼ ..... save all 4 (column)
A + B + ▼ ..... delete slot

Lock: L + R locks saving ("X" shown), against accidental overwriting.
Bank menu: A + B + ▲ copy bank · A + B + ▼ paste bank · B + ▲▼ edit bank name
Transfer: A + B + ▲ send bank · A + B + ▼ receive bank · on error: SELECT cancels, A + B keeps the data.